blatantly violating them. And let us not forget that the murky environment in which we are trying to find the “golden path” is one in which lives are at stake. Every human life is of supreme value, and therefore in the kinds of conflicts we are dealing with I am willing to be moral and to limit myself only to the point at which it is beginning to cost me in human lives. This is what the poet meant in the Book of Psalms when he wrote, “The dead do not praise the Lord.” In an extreme situation in which if I choose to be more moral I will pay with my life, I would rather be less moral and survive. I think this is the basic and natural instinct of all people.

We Israelis live in a divided and polarized society—there is economic polarization, ethnic polarization, religious polarization, and a polarization of values. Public debate is legitimate and healthy only to the point at which our national resilience and our belief in the justice of our path are being harmed. I want to believe that despite our polarization, we are anchored by one common denominator—that we all aspire to live in a Jewish-democratic state. If this common denominator does indeed exist, then anything that weakens it risks our very existence.

In a society as polarized as ours, should the right marker be the liberal intellectual elite, whose language is understood only by its own members? A resident of Sderot, who may not be familiar with all the nuances involved in democracy and Judaism, knows that he is a Jew, that the Land of Israel is the Promised Land, and that his children risk their lives every day as they make their way to Be’er Sheva. And the people who endanger them are Palestinian terrorists. Period. He expects his prime minister and the IDF to do everything possible in order for his children not to be in danger, without laboriously pondering the specific moral dimensions of the measure that should be taken to remove the risk. The things I am writing may come across as politically incorrect, and could even be painted by some as being fascist, God forbid. It is commonly agreed that the majority of Israelis support a two-state solution, but as long as no diplomatic negotiations are taking place, behavior is determined by what is happening on the ground. And what is happening is a violent conflict, in which, in my humble opinion, the calculation is between being more moral and dying, or being less moral and surviving. The second option is the one that will prevail because it is the product of a human existential instinct. Because I come from the world of practice and not from the world of thought, I try to challenge my views with those opinions that are, as I see it, the exact